

Shannon and Dana Gorbahn Family Christmas Letter 2013

Merry Christmas everyone! We want you all to know that life is good in Smithers and we have had such a wonderful year and are looking forward to the future! We are busy but we are surviving the challenges that are in front of us! We wish you all the best and may this Christmas Season give you all the joy that we can have!

Jadyn

So far, so good. Just started high school, grade 8 and loving it. I've been really working hard and got one of my best report card!! Still hanging out with my good old friends, and made some new ones. I've been quite busy with dance and piano. I'm now in jazz and hip hop. I started tap but didn't really like it. I'm working at Gone Hollywood. On Saturdays and really enjoying it. I went to a Taylor Swift concert with my mom in Vancouver. This year we're going to go to Arizona for Christmas. I cannot wait to be with my family in one of my most favourite places!! We're going to get to take some really nice family pictures in a beautiful park. It will be our last Christmas with my brother Kai before he heads off on his mission. I'm really going to miss him and I'm so proud of him. Can't wait to see you all at the next family reunion!!!! Love you all!!

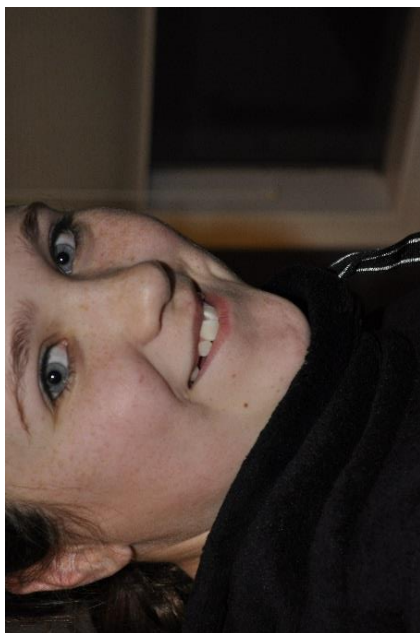


Kaleb

I have been doing a lot this past year. I did lots of golf. Our high school golf team did very well; unfortunately, I was not able to attend Provincials because I was MacDuff in our school play. That was a lot of work but fun. Over the summer I got to go to BYU for their elite golf camp. I also played in some big championships and was able to qualify for the Canadian Amateur Championship. An unfortunate event at the Juvenile Championships was that the person keeping my score missed my last hole and I signed the scorecard and got disqualified. That was heartbreaking. I spend much of my extra time with my girlfriend Jenny. In school, I have been active with both the basketball and volleyball teams.

Taaron

Hi everyone! As some of you know, I am now living in Victoria BC with my wonderful girlfriend. I really really miss my mom and dad. I am studying Business Administration in the Entertainment sector. Although, I am looking at other study topics. It is really interesting and I am really enjoying school and living down here. I found that I needed to find a part time job so that we can live. I had an opportunity to work on a movie set in Langley and Vancouver. I needed to take the ferry over and then a couple of trains, taxis, and car rides to get to the sets. It was all worth it since I got to meet M. Knight Shymalan (who is one of my favorite film makers). That was exciting. I love my Chloe and I really really miss my mom and dad!



Gorbahn Challenge

I have to report about this (tradition). Unfortunately, all of the events were not held except for the golf. And needless to say, I won! Although, I must admit – Luke has dramatically improved and I was down part way through the match. Nice try Captain Lucky (Luke).

Kai

I've been called to serve in the San Jose, California mission! I report to the MTC on January 7th. I've been waiting a very long time to leave. (Too long!) During the wait, I've been living at home with Mom and Dad.... saving up, and living the good life. Mom makes me food and I have close to no bills. It's been a lot of fun here in Smithers. I had an excellent summer, doing lots of golfing, and going on camping trips– connecting with nature and God. Hope all is well with all of you! Much love,



Mom

It has been a great year of wonderful blessings, I cannot believe how fast this year has went. Taaron off to college, Kai moved home to get ready for his mission, Kaleb in his last year of high school, wow so busy with sports and school we hardly see him, and Jadyn in her first year of high school, involved in dance and piano, she is getting so good. We are just beaming with pride our children are our greatest blessing. I enjoyed the “Girl’s Trip” to Arizona with my sister-in-laws and Mom Gorbahn. I have been doing a little work for the Ministry for Children and Families, I worked with a high risk youth for 6 months helping her with independence, I now am working a few hours a week with an 11 year old boy, we pretty much do fun stuff and it gives his foster mom a little break. I have decided to get in shape so in September I hired a personal trainer and we work out 6 days a week, I have also added a spin class and 2 hot yoga classes, I feel great! Wishing you all a beautiful Christmas.



Dad

Life is really good and I have been blessed to have such a wonderful family. The joy in life is from them and the relationships that bind us. I have again been busy both at work and play. Lots of traveling this year. One short family trip to Kaleb’s Canadian Amateur and to Florida for another golf tournament of Kaleb. I got to connect with Luke in Arizona to play some golf. A temple trip and tons of travel because of work. I enjoy going with Kaleb to his many golf events and as the high school golf coach. I live vicariously through him a bit. I was selected to ref Provincial Basketball Championships. I am excited for the life-long blessings and experiences that await Kai as he serves the Lord. Taaron and Chloe are in our prayers always and we miss them dearly but are excited for their futures. Jaddy is one beautiful young women. And my wife is one sexy hot LADY!